

The 6th Tool: Cybernetic Baseball Performance Training

Part 2: Advanced Target Engineering and Daily Maintenance (Modules 5-7)

This document continues from Part 1 (Modules 1-4)

MODULE 5: Architecting the Impossible

The Super Achievement Protocol

Total Teaching Time: 4-5 hours **Prerequisites:** Modules 1-4 complete **Key Concept:** "Impossible" goals become systematically achievable through proper formatting and UPL raising

Section 5.1: The Unconscious Performance Limit (UPL)

Teaching Duration: 60 minutes lecture + diagnostic exercise

Understanding Plateaus: Why Players Get "Stuck"

One of the most frustrating phenomena in athletic development is the **performance plateau**—the player who reaches a certain level (e.g., .240 batting average, 15 home runs per season) and remains there despite consistent training, coaching, and effort.

Conventional Analysis: Physical limitations, lack of talent, or insufficient work ethic

Cybernetic Analysis: The Unconscious Performance Limit (UPL)

Unconscious Performance Limit (UPL): A self-imposed ceiling where the unconscious associates performance above a certain threshold with threats to ego survival, identity stability, or social safety. The UPL functions as a homeostatic mechanism—whenever performance approaches the limit, the unconscious activates subtle sabotage to maintain the "safe" level.

Why UPLs Exist: The Paradox of Success

From conscious perspective: Higher performance = better outcomes

From unconscious perspective: Higher performance triggers multiple threat categories

Threat Category 1: Pressure Amplification

"If I hit .320 instead of .240, expectations will rise proportionally. I'll become 'the guy who hits .320,' and everyone will expect me to sustain it. What if I can't? The failure will be more visible and more humiliating than failing at .240."

Threat Category 2: Identity Destabilization

"I've always been 'a solid .240 hitter'—that's who I am. If I suddenly start hitting .320, I don't know who that person is. That's not me. It feels fake, like I'm pretending to be someone I'm not."

Threat Category 3: Social Disruption

"If I become the star player, my relationships will change. Teammates might resent me or expect me to carry them. I might lose the camaraderie of being 'one of the guys.' Success might isolate me."

Threat Category 4: Failure Risk

"At .240, I know I can sustain that level—it feels within my control. At .320, I'm not sure I could maintain it. It's safer to stay at a level I'm confident I can sustain than to reach higher and risk falling back down publicly."

Critical Insight: These fears operate entirely unconsciously. The player doesn't consciously think, "I'd better not hit too well or I'll face more pressure."

Manifestation: Subtle unconscious sabotage—slight mechanical changes under pressure, mental distractions in key situations, or inexplicable loss of aggressive approach when performance rises above the UPL.

Identifying Your Personal UPL: The 120% Test

The UPL can be diagnosed through a simple but revealing test based on **intuitive certainty rating**.

The Protocol:

1. **Identify Your Goal:** What's your target for this season? (e.g., hit .300)
2. **Rate Certainty at Goal Level:** "On a scale of 1-10, what's your intuitive certainty that you WILL achieve .300 by season's end? Not 'it's possible' or 'I hope to'—but genuine certainty that it WILL happen."
3. **Test at 120% of Goal:** "Now imagine you're REQUIRED to hit .360 (120% of .300). What's your intuitive certainty that you will hit .360?"

Interpretation:

If certainty at 120% is below 10/10, a UPL exists somewhere between your goal and 120% of your goal.

Example:

- Player's goal: Hit .300
- Certainty at .300: 7/10 (already indicates possible UPL right at goal level)
- Certainty at .360: 3/10 (confirms UPL exists below .360)

The player's unconscious believes performance above approximately .310-.320 threatens something important.

Refining the UPL Location: Test "What's your certainty at .310? .320? .330?" until participant finds where certainty drops sharply.

Diagnostic Exercise (20 minutes)

Have all participants complete this test for their primary statistical goal (batting average, home runs, RBIs, stolen bases, ERA for pitchers).

Record:

- Goal
- Certainty at goal (1-10)
- Certainty at 120% of goal (1-10)
- The approximate level where certainty drops below 8

Facilitate Discussion:

"What happens in your body or thoughts when you imagine achieving 120% of your goal? Do you feel any BBFs? Do thoughts arise like 'That's not realistic' or 'I'm not that good' or 'The pressure would be too much'? These are UPL signals."

Section 5.2: The Super Achievement (SA) Objective Format

Teaching Duration: 90 minutes lecture + structured creation exercise

Why Standard Goals Fail: The Formatting Problem

Most goal-setting violates principles that the unconscious requires for target lock-on.

Common goals:

- "I want to hit .300 this season"
- "I want to make varsity"
- "I want to get a scholarship"
- "I want to be more confident"

Problems:

- Not precisely quantified (Scholarship to where? Division I, II, III?)
- Lack timeline specificity ("This season" but what date exactly?)
- Passive voice or vague agency ("Make varsity" = being selected by someone else)
- Not stated positively ("Don't strike out" focuses on the negative)

- Missing boundary conditions (No statement about maintaining health, ethics, relationships)

Solution: The **Super Achievement Objective** format—11 rigorous criteria designed to create an unconscious target that is simultaneously crystal-clear, compelling, and safe.

The 11 SA Criteria Explained

Criterion 1: DESIRABLE (10/10 in Passion)

The objective must represent something the participant genuinely, passionately wants—not what they think they "should" want, or what parents/coaches want, or what would look good.

The unconscious can detect inauthenticity and won't prioritize targets that lack genuine emotional charge.

Test: "If this goal were accomplished, would you feel absolute satisfaction and joy, or would you feel relief/obligation?"

Criterion 2: DIFFICULT (8-10/10 in Logic-Based Challenge)

The objective must be ambitious enough to require unconscious resources and growth. If it's too easy (difficulty 1-3), the unconscious won't allocate high priority because normal effort suffices.

Sweet spot: 8-10 difficulty—logically seems very challenging but not literally impossible.

Test: "Does achieving this goal require becoming a better version of yourself, or could your current self accomplish it with modest effort?"

Criterion 3: SINGLE-FOCUSED (One Primary Aim)

This is perhaps the most violated criterion.

The unconscious can only maintain ONE high-priority target at a time. Objectives like "Hit .300 AND win the batting title AND make all-conference AND get recruited by Division I schools" create target bifurcation—the guidance system doesn't know which destination to prioritize.

■ The Rule of One: One SA Objective = One Primary Measurable Outcome

Solution for Complexity: Use **Subsidiary Targets** (Section 5.3) to bundle multiple desired elements into a single named data packet referenced in the main objective.

Example of Proper Single Focus: "On or before July 31, 2026, I will have hit at least .315 for the season while maintaining everything described in my 'Elite Hitter' subsidiary target."

Criterion 4: TIME-BASED (Specific Deadline)

"Someday" is not a date the unconscious can lock onto. Every SA Objective requires a specific deadline: "On or before [Month] [Day], [Year]..."

Why this matters: The unconscious uses the deadline to allocate resources and create urgency. Without a deadline, there's no temporal reference point for progress evaluation.

Criterion 5: COMPREHENSIVE (All Boundary Conditions)

The objective must include protective boundaries that prevent destructive optimization paths.

Common boundary conditions:

- "While remaining healthy and injury-free"
- "While maintaining my love for the game"
- "While preserving important relationships"
- "While acting with integrity"

These clauses prevent: Unconscious from "achieving" the goal through unacceptable means (e.g., staying healthy via getting others injured, or achieving stats at cost of team success).

Criterion 6: LOWER LIMIT (Specifies Minimum, Not Maximum)

Use "at least" language rather than "exactly": "I will hit at least .315" not "I will hit .315."

Why: Prevents unconscious interpretation that .320 is "too much" or that exceeding the target is somehow wrong. The objective defines a floor, not a ceiling.

Criterion 7: QUANTIFIED (Measured in Specific Numbers)

Abstract qualities must be translated into measurable outcomes. "Be more confident" is not measurable. "Hit .315 with 25 home runs, demonstrating aggressive approach" provides concrete feedback signals.

Criterion 8: PROACTIVE (Every Sentence Begins with "I")

This keeps agency focused on what the participant will DO, not on what they hope will happen or what others will do.

Wrong: "The scouts will notice me" (dependent on others) *Right:* "I will perform at a level that naturally attracts scout attention"

Criterion 9: POSITIVE (Stated in Positive Terms)

The unconscious doesn't process negation efficiently. "Don't strike out" focuses attention on striking out.

Wrong: "I won't be tentative" (focuses on tentativeness) *Right:* "I will be aggressively decisive" (focuses on desired state)

Criterion 10: WRITTEN (Recorded by Hand)

The SA Objective must be written out by hand, not just typed or thought. Handwriting engages kinesthetic and visual-motor systems that strengthen encoding.

Criterion 11: INSURANCE (Includes "Highest Good" Statement)

Every SA Objective must conclude with:

"Please make this happen in ways that are for the highest good of me and of all concerned."

This is not optional or "spiritual"—it's a practical safety mechanism that constrains optimization to ethical paths.

Structured SA Objective Creation Exercise (45 minutes)

Phase 1: Objective Drafting (15 minutes)

Participants write their first draft SA Objective for their season-end hitting goal using this template:

"On or before [DATE], I will have [ACCOMPLISHED AT LEAST X MEASURABLE OUTCOME], while [BOUNDARY CONDITIONS]. I will have done this through/by [KEY METHODS OR QUALITIES], [ADDITIONAL QUANTIFIABLE SUB-GOALS]. Please make this happen in ways that are for the highest good of me and of all concerned."

Example:

"On or before October 31, 2026, I will have hit at least .315 for my high school season with at least 8 home runs and at least 40 RBIs, while remaining healthy, happy, and maintaining my love for baseball and my important relationships. I will have done this through exceptional bat speed, disciplined pitch recognition, and an aggressively patient approach at the plate. Please make this happen in ways that are for the highest good of me and of all concerned."

Phase 2: Criteria Audit (15 minutes)

Participants review their draft against all 11 criteria using the **SA Objective Checklist**:

Criterion	Present?	Needs Revision?
Desirable (10/10)	Y/N	Notes
Difficult (8-10/10)	Y/N	Notes
Single-Focused	Y/N	Notes
Time-Based	Y/N	Notes
Comprehensive	Y/N	Notes
Lower Limit ("at least")	Y/N	Notes
Quantified	Y/N	Notes
Proactive ("I will")	Y/N	Notes
Positive Language	Y/N	Notes
Written by Hand	Y/N	Notes
Insurance Statement	Y/N	Notes

Phase 3: Partner Review and Revision (15 minutes)

Pair participants to review each other's SA Objectives, specifically checking for:

- Is this THEIR goal or someone else's? (Desirability test)
- Are there multiple primary aims competing? (Single focus test)
- Is ANY phrasing negative? (Positive language test)
- Would achieving this in a destructive way technically fulfill the words? (Insurance statement and boundary conditions test)

Revise until all 11 criteria are solidly met.

Section 5.3: Managing Complexity with Subsidiary Targets

Teaching Duration: 60 minutes lecture + creation exercise

The Complexity Problem

Many worthy goals are inherently multifaceted. A player wanting to become an "elite hitter" doesn't just want

one statistic—they want a comprehensive excellence profile: hitting for average, showing power, handling all pitch types, performing in clutch situations, displaying proper approach, etc.

Problem: Listing all these elements in the main SA Objective violates the "Rule of One" by creating multiple foci.

Solution: Subsidiary Targets

Subsidiary Target: A separate document that bundles multiple detailed characteristics into a named package. The main SA Objective references this package by name, keeping the primary objective single-focused while allowing complexity to be managed systematically.

The Architecture

Main SA Objective: *"On or before October 31, 2026, I will have easily achieved everything described in my 'Elite Power Hitter' subsidiary target, while remaining healthy and happy..."*

Subsidiary Target Document (separate page titled "Elite Power Hitter"): A detailed list of specific characteristics, each defined experientially (this process will be taught in Module 6—for now, participants list them in written form).

Creating a Subsidiary Target: Structured Process

Step 1: Identify Key Elements (10 minutes)

Brainstorm all specific characteristics that define your desired outcome. For "Elite Power Hitter," this might include:

Physical Performance Metrics:

- Hit at least .315 batting average
- Hit at least 25 home runs
- Show exceptional bat speed (90+ mph exit velocity)

Approach and Recognition:

- Demonstrate all-fields power (not just pull-side)
- Handle elite velocity (95+ mph fastballs)
- Recognize and adjust to breaking balls
- Maintain aggressive approach in all counts
- Display proper plate discipline (walk rate 10%+)

Mechanical Excellence:

- Display exceptional bat speed

- Maintain loose, athletic swing mechanics
- Show quick hands and strong lower body drive

Mental/Competitive:

- Display confident, competitive presence
- Perform consistently in pressure situations

Step 2: Group and Organize (10 minutes)

Organize elements into logical categories (shown above).

Step 3: Experiential Definition Prep (Module 6 preview)

Note that each characteristic will eventually need an experiential definition (using the Key Elements to Experiences protocol from Module 6). For now, participants should recognize that these written characteristics are placeholders that will be translated into multi-sensory imaginary experiences.

Step 4: Naming and Referencing

Choose a specific, evocative name for the Subsidiary Target that captures its essence:

- "Elite Power Hitter"
- "Complete Offensive Player"
- "Clutch Performer Profile"

Then reference this name in the main SA Objective, treating it as a single bundled unit.

Practice Exercise (25 minutes)

Participants create their own Subsidiary Target for their SA Objective:

1. List 8-15 specific characteristics that define complete achievement of their goal
2. Organize into logical categories
3. Choose a compelling name
4. Rewrite their main SA Objective to reference the Subsidiary Target by name
5. Test: Does the main objective now have single focus while still being comprehensive?

Section 5.4: Raising the UPL: The 120% Buffer

Teaching Duration: 45 minutes lecture + application

Why You Must Set the UPL Above Your Goal

If your UPL (Unconscious Performance Limit) sits at or below your SA Objective, the unconscious will sabotage achievement to maintain the "safe" limit.

Solution: Deliberately raise your UPL to 120% of your actual goal, making your goal feel "safe" by comparison.

The Logic:

- Your actual goal: Hit .300
- Your unconscious needs to feel safe at: .360 (120% of .300)
- When .360 feels achievable and non-threatening, .300 becomes "easy" for the unconscious to allow

The Mechanism: Desensitization Through Imagination

Just as the mortality meditation in Module 3 created survival-level prioritization by making you imagine death, the 120% buffer raises the UPL by making you imagine and become comfortable with performance above your goal.

Key principle: The unconscious treats vivid imagination similarly to actual experience, so repeatedly imagining yourself succeeding at 120% desensitizes the threat response.

The UPL Raising Protocol

Step 1: Identify the UPL Blocker

Imagine being REQUIRED to achieve 120% of your goal. Notice what BBFs arise. These are the UPL blocker signals.

"I'm required to hit .360 this season. If I don't, [some terrible consequence]. Notice what you feel in your body and what thoughts arise."

Common UPL blocker thoughts:

- "The pressure would be unbearable"
- "Everyone would expect me to be perfect"
- "I'd lose my authenticity/humility"
- "I'd become arrogant"
- "Teammates would resent me"
- "I couldn't sustain that—I'd eventually fail publicly"

Step 2: Find the Root Memory (RNBR Application)

Use the time machine technique from Module 4:

"Take me back to the earliest appropriate memory where I learned that standing out/excelling was dangerous."

Common root memories for UPLs:

- Being teased or isolated for being "too good" (age 8-13)
- A parent or coach warning against arrogance (age 7-12)
- Witnessing someone else who was successful being criticized or rejected (age 6-14)
- Achieving success then experiencing overwhelming pressure that led to failure (age 10-16)

Step 3: Reframe the Root

Create a perfect 10/10 version of the memory where excellence was celebrated healthily, pressure was manageable, and success didn't create isolation or overwhelming expectations.

Original Memory: "I hit three home runs in a game when I was 11. Afterward, my teammates seemed cold, and one said, 'You think you're so great now.' I felt guilty for standing out."

Reframed: "I hit three home runs in a game when I was 11. Afterward, my teammates congratulated me genuinely. Several said, 'That was awesome! You really helped us win.' My coach pulled me aside and said, 'Great game. Stay humble, keep working, and enjoy your success—you earned it.' I felt proud without guilt, realizing that excellence can inspire others and that I could succeed without losing connection."

Step 4: Install the 120% Target as "Normal"

Once the root blocker is cleared, repeatedly visualize yourself achieving 120% of your goal, making it feel normal and safe:

"See yourself hitting .360. Experience what that's like: consistent success, enjoyment, confidence, teammates appreciating your contribution, handling any increased attention with maturity. Make this feel like a natural expression of your ability, not a threat to your identity or relationships."

Repeat this visualization daily for two weeks until .360 feels as safe as .300 previously did.

Step 5: Retest Certainty

After the reframing and repeated 120% visualization, retest: "What's your intuitive certainty of hitting .360?"

If it's risen to 8-10/10, the UPL has been successfully raised, and your actual goal of .300 now sits comfortably within your "safe zone."

Section 5.5: The SA Target Process Preview

Teaching Duration: 30 minutes lecture

From Written Objective to Experiential Target

The SA Objective format provides the *coordinates*, but the unconscious needs the *experience*.

Module 6 will teach the complete Target Process for translating your written SA Objective into multi-sensory imaginary experiences. For now, participants need to understand why this translation is necessary.

The Limitation of Words

Your SA Objective might state: "I will have exceptional bat speed."

This phrase has meaning for your conscious, linguistic mind.

But your unconscious—which actually controls motor output—doesn't process abstract concepts.

It needs:

- **Visual:** What does exceptional bat speed look like? The blur of the bat, the ball jumping off the barrel, the center fielder's reaction
- **Kinesthetic:** What does exceptional bat speed feel like? The effortless explosion through the zone, the perfect timing, the sensation of power
- **Auditory:** What does exceptional bat speed sound like? The sharp crack of contact
- **Emotional:** What does exceptional bat speed feel like emotionally? Confidence, satisfaction, flow

Preview Assignment

After completing their SA Objective and Subsidiary Target, participants should begin thinking about:

"If I were to close my eyes and vividly experience having just achieved this goal, what would that moment feel like? What would I see, hear, feel in my body, and feel emotionally?"

This preview primes them for the detailed Target Process work in Module 6.

Module 5 Integration: From Limited to Limitless

Teaching Duration: 30 minutes synthesis + assignment

The Transformation Summary

Before Module 5:

- Plateaus seemed like natural limits of talent or work ethic
- Goals were set in standard formats that the unconscious couldn't fully prioritize
- The idea of "impossible" objectives seemed like wishful thinking
- Fear of success sabotaged achievement unconsciously

After Module 5:

- UPLs are understood as unconscious safety mechanisms that can be raised
- SA Objectives provide formatting that bypasses unconscious resistance
- "Impossible" goals become systematically achievable through proper target engineering
- Success becomes safe through root blocker resolution and 120% buffer installation

Key Insight:

"You've learned that your greatest limitation isn't physical talent—it's your unconscious belief about how much success is 'safe' for you. The UPL acts like a governor on an engine, limiting output to protect the system. But you're not actually protecting yourself by staying small; you're protecting an outdated childhood identity. By raising your UPL through reframing and desensitization, and by formatting your objectives to meet all 11 SA criteria, you give your unconscious permission to pursue excellence fully. The 'impossible' becomes possible not through superhuman effort but through removing unconscious barriers and providing precise guidance."

Assignment for Integration

Before Module 6, participants must:

1. Complete SA Objective:

- Written by hand
- All 11 criteria verified
- Subsidiary Target created if needed
- Read aloud 25 times while monitoring for BBFs

2. UPL Work:

- Identify your UPL through the 120% test
- If certainty at 120% is below 8, complete RNBR on the blocker
- Begin daily visualization of achieving 120% of your goal

3. Certainty Tracking:

- Each morning, rate your intuitive certainty of achieving your SA Objective (1-10)
- Journal: What thoughts or feelings accompany high certainty days? Low certainty days?
- This data reveals which blockers may still be active

The Bridge to Module 6

"You now have a rigorously formatted SA Objective that your conscious mind can clearly understand. Module 6 will translate this objective into the experiential language your unconscious actually uses—converting abstract concepts like 'exceptional bat speed' into vivid, multi-sensory imaginary experiences. This translation creates

the Endpoint Success Image (EPSI), the ultimate target your bio-computer will lock onto and automatically pursue. The EPSI is what transforms your SA Objective from an idea into a neurological reality."

MODULE 6: Translating Words into Experiences

The Target Process for Multi-Sensory Programming

Total Teaching Time: 4-5 hours **Prerequisites:** Modules 1-5 complete **Key Concept:** The unconscious speaks in experiences, not words; translation is essential for target lock-on

Section 6.1: The Language Barrier Between Conscious and Unconscious

Teaching Duration: 45 minutes lecture + demonstration

Why the Unconscious Doesn't Understand Words

The fundamental challenge in unconscious programming is that your conscious mind speaks **language** (linear, symbolic, abstract) while your unconscious speaks **experience** (simultaneous, concrete, sensory).

When you write "I will hit with exceptional bat speed," your conscious mind processes this as a clear instruction. Your unconscious, which controls the motor systems that actually generate bat speed, receives essentially meaningless noise—abstract symbols without actionable coordinates.

The Translation Imperative: Every written element of your SA Objective must be translated into experiential form—vivid, multi-sensory imaginary experiences that the unconscious can process as templates for future behavior.

The Neurological Basis

Research on motor imagery demonstrates that the brain activates similar neural patterns when vividly imagining an action as when actually performing it (though at reduced intensity).

This means:

- Imagining yourself swinging with exceptional bat speed activates motor cortex, basal ganglia, and cerebellum similarly to actual swinging
- The unconscious treats these activations as "practice"—strengthening the neural pathways for the imagined action
- With sufficient repetition and vividness, imaginary experiences can enhance actual performance measurably

However, this only works if the imaginary experience is **concrete and sensory-rich**, not abstract and linguistic.

"Swing faster" doesn't activate motor systems.

Imagining your hips exploding, hands whipping through the zone, and the ball rocketing off the bat DOES activate motor systems.

The Four Levels of Experience

Effective unconscious programming requires translation across four distinct experiential domains:

1. Physical/Kinesthetic: What you feel in your body

- Muscle tension and relaxation
- Movement sensation and tempo
- Balance and spatial positioning
- Force, speed, and power sensations

2. Sensory/Perceptual: What you perceive through your senses

- **Visual:** What you see—colors, shapes, movements, distances
- **Auditory:** What you hear—sounds of contact, crowd, internal silence
- **Other senses:** Smell of grass, taste in your mouth (if relevant)

3. Emotional/Affective: What you feel emotionally

- Confidence, excitement, calm, satisfaction, joy, determination
- NOT anxiety, fear, or negative emotions (those indicate blockers needing resolution)

4. Cognitive/Meaning: What you think or understand

- Realizations, insights, beliefs activated
- Self-talk that emerges naturally (not forced)
- Sense of certainty or knowing

Demonstration: Single Phrase Translation

Take the phrase "exceptional bat speed" and translate it across all four levels:

Physical/Kinesthetic: *"My lower body coils with spring-loaded tension, then explodes forward. My hips fire first, creating a whip-like chain reaction up through my torso. My hands stay back until the last possible moment, then rip through the zone with zero wasted motion. The bat feels light, moving so fast it's almost a blur. The contact is effortless—the ball jumps off the bat with no resistance."*

Sensory/Perceptual: *"I see the pitcher's release point clearly. As the ball travels toward me, it seems to slow down, giving me all the time I need. I see the rotation of the seams. My peripheral vision picks up the ball's"*

location precisely. At contact, I hear a sharp, satisfying crack that echoes. The ball streaks on a line—I see it carrying, carrying, then clearing the fence."

Emotional/Affective: *"I feel calm and confident. There's an aggressive certainty—I know I'm about to drive this ball. After contact, satisfaction and joy flood through my chest. I feel powerful but controlled, explosive but smooth."*

Cognitive/Meaning: *"I realize: this is my swing. This is who I am when I trust myself. I don't have to try hard to generate speed—it's natural. I think, 'I was born to hit.'"*

Notice how much richer the experience is compared to the original phrase. This richness is what the unconscious needs to create behavioral templates.

Section 6.2: The Three-Step Translation Protocol

Teaching Duration: 90 minutes lecture + guided practice

Overview of the Key Elements to Experiences Process

The Target Process converts each **Key Element** (important phrase or concept in your SA Objective and Subsidiary Target) into an experiential definition through three steps:

1. **Find an Associated Memory** (6/10 approximation)
2. **Tune to Perfect 10** (Imaginary Experience creation)
3. **Anchor with Instructions** (Explicit binding of word-to-experience)

Step 1: Identify and Extract Key Elements

Teaching Duration: 20 minutes

From your written SA Objective and Subsidiary Target, identify the core phrases that require experiential definition.

These are typically:

- **Performance qualities:** "exceptional bat speed," "disciplined pitch recognition," "clutch performance"
- **Desired outcomes:** "driving the ball to all fields," "handling elite velocity," "productive at-bats"
- **Mental/emotional states:** "confident and aggressive approach," "calm under pressure," "competitive fire"
- **Mechanical characteristics:** "quick hands," "staying back on breaking balls," "short, compact swing"

Exercise: Participants highlight or underline 5-8 Key Elements from their SA Objective and Subsidiary Target that feel most critical to their success.

Step 2: Find Associated Memories (6/10 Level)

Teaching Duration: 20 minutes instruction + 15 minutes practice

For each Key Element, you'll search your memory banks for an experience that approximates the element—it doesn't need to be perfect (that's why it's rated 6/10).

Instructions to Participants:

"Take your first Key Element—let's say 'exceptional bat speed.' Ask yourself: When have I experienced something close to this? It might be:

- *A specific swing in a game or practice where your bat felt exceptionally fast*
- *A time when you hit a ball harder than you expected*
- *Even experiences outside baseball—a tennis serve that felt explosive, throwing a ball with snap*

"The memory doesn't need to be perfect. If you remember a swing that felt 'pretty fast' (6/10), that's your starting point. Close your eyes and recall that moment as vividly as possible."

Why Start with Memory Rather Than Pure Imagination?

Memories contain rich, authentic sensory detail that imagination alone often lacks. By starting with a real memory (even if imperfect), you ground the imaginary experience in actual neural patterns your brain has encoded. This makes the eventual "tuned to 10" version more neurologically potent.

Practice (15 minutes):

Participants work through 2-3 of their Key Elements, finding associated memories for each and rating them 1-10 on how closely the memory matches the desired element.

Step 3: Tune to Perfect 10 (Create the Imaginary Experience)

Teaching Duration: 20 minutes instruction + 20 minutes guided practice

This is the creative core of the Target Process: taking your 6/10 memory and editing it with imagination until it becomes a perfect 10/10 representation of the Key Element.

Instructions to Participants:

"Now you're going to use your imagination like a film editor, taking your 6/10 memory and enhancing it until it perfectly represents what you intuitively mean by [Key Element]. You're allowed to:

- *Amplify what was good: Make the bat speed even faster, the contact even more solid*
- *Remove what was imperfect: Delete any hesitation, tension, or mechanical flaw*
- *Add what was missing: Include sensory details that make the experience richer*
- *Intensify emotions: Make the satisfaction and confidence at 10/10 levels*

"Keep editing until you can say with complete honesty: 'This imaginary experience is EXACTLY what I mean by [Key Element]. It's perfect—I couldn't make it better.' That's when it's a true 10/10."

Guided Example: "Exceptional Bat Speed"

Original Memory (6/10): *"I remember a BP pitch last month where I really got my hips through and drove the ball to right-center. It felt pretty good, though my hands were maybe a bit slow."*

Tuning Process:

"Let's enhance this. See that same pitch coming, but now your hands are lightning-fast—not just quick, but the fastest they've ever been. Your lower body fires with perfect timing, creating a kinetic chain that makes your hands explode through the zone. The bat is a blur. Contact is so pure you barely feel it—just the ball launching like it was hit by a cannon. You watch it carry deeper, deeper than any ball you've hit before. You think, 'THAT's my bat speed. That's what I'm capable of.' Your chest fills with satisfaction and power. Rate this version 1-10."

[Participant rates it—if below 10, continue tuning]

"What would make it a perfect 10? [Participant responds: 'I'd like to feel more relaxed while generating that speed.'] Great—add that. See yourself with completely loose shoulders and arms, yet the explosion is even more powerful because there's no tension slowing you down. Now rate it."

[Continue until participant confirms it's a 10/10]

Critical Facilitation Point:

Participants often struggle to give themselves permission to create truly perfect imaginary experiences. They'll say, "But I've never actually hit a ball that hard" or "That seems unrealistic."

Remind them:

"You're not claiming you've done this yet. You're consciously creating a template for your unconscious to pursue. The unconscious doesn't distinguish between vividly imagined and actual experience—it treats both as data. By creating this perfect 10 template, you're programming your bio-computer with an ideal reference point. Trust the process."

Practice (20 minutes):

Participants tune 2-3 of their Key Elements to perfect 10 imaginary experiences, writing brief descriptions of the tuned versions.

Step 4: Anchor with Explicit Instructions

Teaching Duration: 15 minutes instruction + 10 minutes practice

Once you have a perfect 10 imaginary experience for a Key Element, you need to explicitly bind the word/phrase to the experience through a conscious instruction to your unconscious.

The Anchoring Statement:

"This imaginary experience [recall the vivid 10/10 experience] is what I mean by '[Key Element phrase]'. Please anchor this description and experience together inseparably. Whenever I think or say '[Key Element

phrase], 'activate this complete experiential template.'"

Why Explicit Instructions Matter:

The unconscious is extraordinarily literal and precise. Without explicit binding, the word "exceptional bat speed" remains an abstract phrase. With explicit binding, those words become a trigger that activates the full multi-sensory experiential template—complete with kinesthetic sensations, visual imagery, emotional states, and meaning.

Practice (10 minutes):

For each of their tuned Key Elements, participants:

1. Recall the vivid 10/10 imaginary experience
2. Say (internally or aloud) the anchoring statement
3. Repeat 3 times to strengthen the binding

This creates what programmers call a "variable definition": the Key Element phrase is now a label pointing to a rich data structure (the experiential template).

Section 6.3: The Endpoint Success Image (EPSI)

Teaching Duration: 90 minutes lecture + creation workshop

From Component Experiences to Holographic Synthesis

You've now translated each Key Element into an experiential definition. The final step is synthesizing these components into a single, unified experience: the **Endpoint Success Image (EPSI)**.

Endpoint Success Image (EPSI): A holographic, multi-sensory imaginary experience of the moment immediately after successfully achieving your SA Objective. The EPSI integrates all Key Elements into one coherent moment that the unconscious treats as the target destination.

Why the EPSI is Essential

Individual Key Element experiences are like musical notes—important but incomplete. The EPSI is the full symphony, where all elements play simultaneously in harmony.

This creates a **coherent state**—all brain systems aligned on the same target, all experiential components integrated into a unified whole.

The unconscious doesn't navigate toward abstract concepts; it navigates toward **holistic felt experiences**. The EPSI provides that experience.

The EPSI Creation Protocol

Step 1: Identify the Perfect Moment (10 minutes)

The EPSI is NOT an entire season playing out—it's a single, crystallized moment. Specifically, the moment when you've just completed achieving your SA Objective.

Examples of EPSI Moments:

- Standing on first base after your third hit of the game, glancing at the scoreboard and seeing you've just clinched .315 for the season
- Walking off the field after the final game, checking stats on your phone and seeing 26 home runs for the season
- Shaking your coach's hand after the season, hearing him say "You did it—exactly what you set out to do"

Instructions to Participants:

"When and where will you know, definitively, that you've achieved your SA Objective? What's the specific moment of recognition? Close your eyes and let that moment come into focus. Where are you physically? Who's around you? What just happened? This moment is your EPSI anchor."

Step 2: Construct the Multi-Sensory Experience (30 minutes)

Now you'll build out that moment across all experiential dimensions, weaving in all your Key Element experiences.

Guided EPSI Construction:

"You're in that moment of achievement. Let's make it vivid."

Physical/Kinesthetic: *"What do you feel in your body? Maybe you feel energized, strong, loose. Maybe you feel tired but satisfied from a great season. Notice specific sensations: the weight of your gear, the feeling of standing on the base, the texture of your uniform, the feeling of your hands—maybe slightly sore from all the hitting but in a good way."*

Visual: *"What do you see? Look around. What's the lighting like—sun setting on the field? Stadium lights? Notice specific details: the scoreboard with your stats, teammates' faces, the dirt of the infield, your own hands adjusting your batting gloves. Maybe you see your family in the stands. What are their expressions? Make it vivid."*

Auditory: *"What do you hear? Maybe crowd noise fading, teammates talking, the sound of cleats on dirt, someone shouting your name, the ping of bats in the distance, your own breathing, an announcement over the PA system. Or maybe it's quiet—just your internal voice saying something meaningful."*

Emotional: *"What do you feel emotionally? This should be intensely positive—a 10/10 on satisfaction. Maybe it's pride, joy, gratitude, relief, confidence, power, peace. Don't hold back—let this be the most satisfying emotional moment you can imagine related to baseball. Feel it in your chest, your whole body."*

Cognitive/Meaning: *"What do you think or realize in this moment? Maybe 'I did it. I actually did it.' Or 'This is who I am—this is my level.' Or 'All the work paid off.' Or 'I proved to myself what I'm capable of.' Let a meaningful internal statement emerge naturally."*

Step 3: Integrate Key Elements (20 minutes)

Now consciously weave in references to your Key Element experiences:

"As you're in this moment of achievement, you reflect back on what got you here:

- *You remember your exceptional bat speed—see flashes of balls jumping off your bat all season*
- *You remember your disciplined pitch recognition—all those at-bats where you waited for your pitch*
- *You remember your clutch performances—that hit in the big game, that key RBI*

"These aren't separate memories—they're integrated into this moment. You're standing here having achieved your goal BECAUSE you developed all these qualities. Feel the completeness of the achievement."

Step 4: The Holographic Amplification (10 minutes)

Now intensify the entire experience until every component is at perfect 10/10:

"Amplify the visual clarity—make colors brighter, details sharper. Amplify the emotional satisfaction—make it the most fulfilling moment you've ever experienced in baseball. Amplify the kinesthetic sensations—feel the strength and aliveness in your body. Amplify the meaning—make this the moment that defines your breakthrough as a hitter."

"This is your EPSI. This is the moment your unconscious is now tasked with making real. Experience it fully."

Step 5: The Written EPSI Description (20 minutes)

Participants write out their complete EPSI in present-tense, first-person prose (300-500 words), including all sensory dimensions and emotional content.

This written description becomes their **Affirmation**—the document they'll read repeatedly (25 times to "imprint" it) to install the EPSI as a high-priority unconscious target.

Section 6.4: Time-Tripping: Creating Intermediate Waypoints

Teaching Duration: 45 minutes lecture + exercise

The Navigation Enhancement Technique

The EPSI is your final destination, but the unconscious guidance system becomes even more effective when you provide intermediate waypoints along the journey.

Time-Tripping: The process of creating imaginary experiences at strategic dates between now and your SA Objective deadline, showing your unconscious "what success looks like" at various stages.

The Principle

Airline pilots don't aim for a single GPS coordinate thousands of miles away—they navigate through a series of waypoints that keep them on course.

Your unconscious functions similarly: by pre-experiencing success at multiple checkpoints, you create a clearer path and more frequent feedback about whether you're on track.

The Protocol

Identify 3-5 significant dates between now and your SA Objective deadline.

For a season-end goal of October 31st, these might be:

- April 15 (early season, establishing good habits)
- June 1 (midseason, solidifying gains)
- August 15 (late season, maintaining peak)
- September 30 (final push)
- October 31 (achievement day—your EPSI)

For each date, create a brief imaginary experience (not as detailed as the EPSI, just a "snapshot") of what success looks like at that stage.

April 15 Example: *"It's mid-April, and I'm looking at my stats: hitting .290 through the first 15 games. I feel good—I'm seeing the ball well, staying aggressive, trusting my approach. My swing feels smooth. I think: 'I'm on pace. This is how .315 hitters start seasons.' I feel confident and patient—there's a long way to go, and I'm building the right foundation."*

The Mechanism

By pre-experiencing these waypoints, you:

1. Give your unconscious concrete milestones to navigate toward
2. Create realistic expectation calibration (you won't hit .315 from day one—there's a ramp-up)
3. Build in resilience (even if April is .270, you know you can still reach .315 by season's end)
4. Generate more frequent "Am I on track?" feedback signals

Exercise (20 minutes)

Participants identify 3 waypoint dates for their SA Objective and write brief (50-100 word) imaginary experiences for each, showing what "on track" looks like at that stage.

Section 6.5: The Affirmation and Imprinting Protocol

Teaching Duration: 30 minutes lecture + practice

From Experience to Installed Target

You've created your EPSI—a vivid, multi-sensory, emotionally rich imaginary experience of having achieved your SA Objective. Now you need to install it as a high-priority unconscious target through **repetition-based prioritization**.

The Affirmation

Your written EPSI description (the 300-500 word present-tense narrative) becomes your **Affirmation**—the document that translates your SA Objective into unconscious language.

The Imprinting Protocol

To install the EPSI as a high-priority target, you must expose your unconscious to it repeatedly with full attention:

1. **Read the Affirmation slowly, out loud** (or internally with full attention)
2. **Pause after reading to experience the EPSI vividly** (close eyes, feel it for 30 seconds)
3. **Repeat 25 times in a single sitting**

This takes approximately 30-40 minutes and should be done as soon as possible after creating the Affirmation.

Why 25 Repetitions?

The repetition serves multiple functions:

- **Neural pathway strengthening** (Hebbian learning—neurons that fire together wire together)
- **Priority signaling** to the unconscious (repetition = importance)
- **Blocker surfacing** (if any unconscious conflicts exist)